

Seattle Seahawks

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Professional Sports
Revenue	\$620M
Employees	350
Ideal Customer Profile Score	55

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Football Northwest LLC (d/b/a Seattle Seahawks)
Headquarters	Seattle, Washington (Lumen Field)
Founded	1974

Ownership

Currently owned by the Paul G. Allen Trust, managed by Jody Allen as trustee. Active sale process - Allen & Company (investment bank) and Latham & Watkins (legal) leading. NFL rules require 24 of 32 owners to approve any sale.

Footprint

Pacific Northwest (Seattle, Washington). NFL franchise with national brand amplified by Super Bowl LX championship. Lumen Field hosts NFL games and Sounders FC (MLS). Training facility at Virginia Mason Athletic Center in Renton, WA.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

The Seattle Seahawks are a Super Bowl LX champion NFL franchise being sold by the Paul G. Allen estate. The team won the Super Bowl in February 2026 and immediately entered a sale process expected to yield \$7-10B.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Seattle Seahawks's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Forbes 2025 franchise valuation: ~\$5B, expected sale at \$7-10B due to post-Super Bowl premium and NFL scarcity value. Revenue estimated at ~\$620M with NFL media rights comprising the majority. Paul Allen's estate directed the eventual sale of sports holdings to fund philanthropy. Financial health is excellent - a Super Bowl champion with rising franchise values and guaranteed NFL revenue growth through media rights deals. Key consideration: the sale premium means new ownership will have high return expectations that require organizational excellence.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Chuck Arnold - President [PRIORITY TARGET]

Business operations executive who managed the franchise through Paul Allen's ownership

***Outreach rationale:** As the business-side president, Arnold is navigating the most consequential transition in the franchise's*

history. He needs to position the organization for whatever vision the new owner brings - and he's the person who will present the organizational state to prospective buyers.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Jody Allen - Chair/Trustee (Paul G. Allen Trust)

Paul Allen's sister; managed the Allen estate's sports and philanthropic portfolio

Mike Macdonald - Head Coach

Former Baltimore Ravens defensive coordinator; young, innovative coach

John Schneider - General Manager

Long-tenured GM who rebuilt the franchise post-Pete Carroll era

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Seattle Seahawks operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Current structure reflects Paul Allen's stewardship model - stable, long-tenured leadership with clear authority. The ownership transition creates organizational uncertainty: new owners may retain the existing structure (winning formula) or install their own people (common in NFL ownership changes). The gap between sale announcement and closing (potentially 6-12 months) creates a 'lame duck' period where organizational decision-making is complicated by ownership uncertainty.

Culture Signals

The Seahawks' culture is defined by the 'always compete' philosophy established under Pete Carroll and evolved by Mike Macdonald. The Super Bowl win validates the current culture but ownership transitions historically introduce new cultural expectations. The Paul Allen ownership era was characterized by patience, investment, and community engagement - new owners (likely from finance, tech, or PE backgrounds) may bring different operating philosophies. Employee uncertainty during the sale process is inevitable. The Pacific Northwest identity (tech-influenced, community-focused, environmental consciousness) is part of the franchise DNA. [INFERRED: new ownership from outside the Pacific Northwest may create cultural friction with the existing organization and community]

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Seattle Seahawks.

1. 2026-02-18 - Paul Allen estate formally begins Seahawks sale process

Largest potential sports franchise sale in NA history - organizational inflection point

2. 2026-02-09 - Seahawks win Super Bowl LX

Championship validates current culture and raises franchise sale value - but creates organizational preservation challenge

3. 2026-02-18 - Allen & Company and Latham & Watkins engaged to lead sale process

Professional sale process suggests timeline through 2026 offseason - 6-12 month uncertainty window

4. 2023-07-01 - Washington Commanders sold for \$6.05B - sets floor for Seahawks sale price

Market comparable suggests \$7-10B range, with new owner expecting returns that demand organizational excellence

5. 2026-03-01 - NFL free agency and draft decisions being made during ownership uncertainty

Football decisions (contracts, trades, draft) must be made despite uncertain organizational future

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

genuine organizational need (transition management) and timing alignment (now, during the uncertainty window), but spending authority is uncertain during an ownership transition, and the new owner's preferences are unknown. The 'why this is worth the unconventional bet' rationale: if McChrystal helps the Seahawks navigate the transition, the incoming owner (likely a billionaire from tech, finance, or PE) becomes a direct relationship for McChrystal - and that owner likely has other portfolio companies that need McChrystal's help.

Primary Problem

Navigating a 6-12 month ownership transition period where the organization must maintain Super Bowl-caliber operations while preparing for inevitable change under new ownership - preserving what works while building readiness for whatever comes next.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

McChrystal's experience with leadership transitions in high-performing organizations - maintaining operational excellence during command changes while building organizational resilience for whatever the new leader's vision requires. The military parallel: a unit that just succeeded in a major operation facing a change of command must preserve its capability while adapting to new leadership.

Likely Objections to Engagement

Ownership transition may freeze all discretionary spending until new owner is in place

Current leadership may view external advisory as unnecessary for a winning team

New owner (unknown) may have their own preferred advisors

Short engagement window - value must be delivered quickly before ownership closes

Competitive Advisory Landscape

Allen & Company (transaction advisor, not organizational)

Sports-specific ownership transition consultancies (limited market)
Individual executive coaches

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. How are you maintaining organizational focus during the sale process - are football decisions being made differently because of the ownership uncertainty, and how is the coaching staff managing the noise?

Empathetic question that acknowledges the real human challenge of performing at elite level during institutional uncertainty.

2. What organizational 'brief' would you want to hand the new owner - a document that says 'here's how this organization works, here's what makes it special, and here's what you should preserve'?

Positions McChrystal as the partner who can help create that organizational readiness package.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Personal and practical: 'You just won the Super Bowl. Now you're about to hand this organization to someone new. How do you ensure they inherit not just a championship roster but a championship culture?' McChrystal can help codify what makes this organization work.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Seattle Seahawks's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

The Seahawks' brand is at its peak post-Super Bowl LX. The '12th Man' fan culture is among the strongest in the NFL. The Paul Allen legacy (technology, philanthropy, community investment) is embedded in the franchise identity. The brand risk: new ownership that changes the franchise's community-focused identity could alienate the passionate fan base. Brand opportunity: a seamless ownership transition that preserves the championship culture becomes a case study that enhances both the franchise and McChrystal's brand. [INFERRED: brand value is currently at an all-time high, making this the optimal moment to codify organizational culture before transition]

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Seattle Seahawks. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Transition Management

Maintaining championship-caliber operations during a 6-12 month ownership uncertainty window. McChrystal's experience with military command transitions - maintaining operational excellence while leadership changes - is directly applicable. No sports consultancy offers this specific capability.

Fit Dimension 2: Culture Codification

The current winning culture needs to be understood, documented, and made transferable so the new owner can preserve what works. McChrystal's organizational assessment methodology can capture the operating model, decision-making norms, and cultural elements that enabled the Super Bowl championship.

Fit Dimension 3: New Owner Readiness

Preparing the organization for whatever vision the new owner brings - building adaptability without losing identity. McChrystal's work on organizational resilience and adaptability in VUCA environments applies directly.

9b. Cumulative Case

Signal chain: Super Bowl championship -> immediate sale announcement -> 6-12 month uncertainty window -> \$7-10B valuation means new owner has high expectations -> football decisions (free agency, draft) must proceed during uncertainty. The paradox: peak organizational performance coinciding with maximum organizational uncertainty.

Revenue potential: \$200K-\$300K organizational assessment + culture codification (2-3 months), \$150K-\$200K transition advisory during sale process, \$300K+ with new ownership (if relationship continues). Real value: relationship with incoming billionaire owner and their broader portfolio.

Why this unconventional bet is worth it: the incoming Seahawks owner will likely be a billionaire with other companies, investments, and boards. McChrystal's entry through the franchise opens a relationship that extends well beyond sports.

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. **Lame Duck Decision-Making:** During the sale process, major decisions (player contracts, infrastructure investments) may be delayed or constrained by ownership uncertainty.
2. **Employee Anxiety:** Staff at all levels wonder whether new ownership will retain them. Key talent (coaches, scouts, executives) may explore other opportunities as a hedge.
3. **Culture Preservation Challenge:** The elements that produced a championship - trust, communication patterns, decision-making norms - are tacit and may not survive an ownership transition if not explicitly understood and preserved.
4. **Fan/Community Expectations:** Seattle fans and community expect the Paul Allen legacy (community investment, fan-friendly pricing) to continue. New ownership's approach is unknown.
5. **Timeline Pressure:** NFL calendar (free agency, draft, training camp) doesn't pause for ownership transitions.

Football decisions must be made with full commitment despite organizational uncertainty.

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. Organizational Culture Assessment - Documented analysis of what makes the Seahawks' championship culture work. Measurable: comprehensive organizational brief ready for new ownership within 60 days.
2. Transition Readiness Framework - Organization prepared for leadership change with maintained performance. Measurable: key talent retention above 95% through sale process.
3. Decision-Making Continuity - Framework for making consequential football/business decisions during ownership uncertainty. Measurable: zero delayed critical decisions due to ownership ambiguity.
4. New Owner Onboarding Plan - Structured integration plan for incoming ownership. Measurable: new owner operational within 30 days of closing.

9e. Key Stakeholders

Business Operations

Leader: Chuck Arnold

Role: President

McChrystal Relevance: Priority target - navigating transition from business side

Football Operations

Leader: John Schneider

Role: GM

McChrystal Relevance: Long-tenured; his continuity depends on new ownership

Coaching

Leader: Mike Macdonald

Role: Head Coach

McChrystal Relevance: Just won Super Bowl - preservation of coaching culture critical

Trust/Ownership

Leader: Jody Allen

Role: Trustee

McChrystal Relevance: Sale process executor - not long-term stakeholder

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: Sale process announced Feb 2026. The window to influence organizational readiness is during the sale process, not after new ownership arrives. Once a buyer is identified, McChrystal's advisory becomes the buyer's decision - so the engagement must happen now, through the current leadership.

Why McChrystal: Military command transitions are the closest parallel to sports franchise ownership transitions - maintaining operational excellence while leadership changes. No other advisory firm has this specific narrative. Sports consultancies advise on player strategy, not organizational transitions.

Phased Engagement:

- Phase 1 (\$200K-\$300K, 2-3 months): Organizational culture assessment + transition readiness framework.

Beachhead: the culture codification - it's bounded, high-value, and creates a tangible deliverable for new ownership.

- Phase 2 (\$150K-\$200K, through closing): Ongoing transition advisory as sale process progresses.
- Phase 3 (post-closing, \$300K+): New owner integration + organizational advisory for incoming ownership group.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit:

- Thread 1: Chuck Arnold, President - direct approach on ownership transition management
- Thread 2: McChrystal personal network - Seattle tech/business community (Paul Allen's orbit, Microsoft/Amazon connections)
- Thread 3: NFL owner network - McChrystal's existing relationships with NFL ownership groups could facilitate introduction